

Email Basics

Lesson 37 — Addresses, Fields and Folders

JKSSB Computer Awareness

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What Email Is

- ▶ **Electronic mail (email)** is a message sent from one electronic mailbox to another over a network such as the Internet.
- ▶ Each user has a unique **email address**; each message goes from a sender's mailbox to one or more recipients' mailboxes.
- ▶ A message has an **envelope** (who it goes to) and **content** (subject plus body, with optional attachments).
- ▶ Email is **store-and-forward**: it waits in the recipient's mailbox until it is opened.

The one idea

An address identifies the mailbox; fields direct the message; folders store it.

Anatomy of an Email Address

- ▶ Every address has exactly one @ symbol, read as “at”.
- ▶ The @ separates the **user name** on the left from the **domain name** on the right. (PYQ-35)
- ▶ Example: in assistant@gmail.com, assistant is the user name and gmail.com is the domain name.
- ▶ The domain name tells which mail server holds the mailbox; the user name tells which mailbox on that server.

Trap alert

@ separates user name and domain name — not domain and host, and not two parts of the domain.

To, Cc and Bcc

Field	Full form	Who sees it
To	Primary recipient	Seen by all recipients
Cc	Carbon Copy	Seen by all recipients
Bcc	Blind Carbon Copy	Hidden from other recipients

- ▶ **To** names the main recipient; **Cc** keeps others visibly in the loop.
- ▶ **Bcc** hides its recipients from **each other**; To and Cc addresses stay visible to all.
(TRAP-16)

Bcc: What “Hidden” Really Means

- ▶ A Bcc recipient receives the message like anyone else.
- ▶ Other To, Cc, and Bcc recipients **cannot see** who was on Bcc.
- ▶ The **sender** always knows the full list; “hidden” means hidden from each other, not from the sender.
- ▶ Use Bcc for a large or confidential distribution list where addresses must stay private.

Trap alert

Bcc hides recipients from each other. It does not hide the sender, and it does not hide To/Cc from anyone.

Subject, Body and Attachments

- ▶ **Subject**: one short line stating the topic; it is shown in the message list before the message is opened.
- ▶ **Body**: the main written content of the message.
- ▶ **Attachment**: a file sent along with the message, shown with a paperclip icon in most programs.
- ▶ The To/Cc/Bcc fields direct the message; subject, body, and attachments are what the recipient reads.

Keep the triple straight

Subject says what it is about; body says the message; attachment carries the file.

Attachment Essentials

- ▶ Common attachments: documents, spreadsheets, presentations, PDFs, images.
- ▶ Mail servers set a **size limit**; an oversize file is rejected or must be shared as a link instead.
- ▶ An attachment can carry a **virus**, so unexpected attachments must not be opened blindly.
- ▶ Sending a file means sending a **copy**; the original stays with the sender.

Office desktop example

The assistant types the covering note in the body and attaches the typed notice as a PDF — the body explains, the attachment carries the file.

Inbox, Sent and Drafts

Folder	What it holds
Inbox	Incoming messages received
Sent	Copies of messages already sent
Drafts	Composed messages saved but not yet sent

A sent message leaves a copy in Sent; an unfinished message waits in Drafts.

Spam and Trash

- ▶ **Spam (junk)**: unwanted or bulk messages filtered out of the Inbox automatically.
- ▶ **Trash (deleted items)**: messages the user deleted; they stay recoverable until the folder is emptied.
- ▶ Emptying Trash or the Spam folder **permanently removes** those messages.
- ▶ A wanted message found in Spam must be moved back or marked “not spam”.

Keep the pair straight

Spam holds suspected junk; Trash holds what the user deleted.

Reply, Reply All and Forward

Action	What it does
Reply	Answers only the sender
Reply All	Answers the sender plus all To and Cc recipients
Forward	Sends the message on to new recipients

- ▶ Reply All **never** re-adds Bcc addresses; they stay hidden.
- ▶ A forwarded message may include the original attachments.

Reply vs Forward: A Worked Exchange

- ▶ The officer mails the notice To the assistant, Cc the clerk.
- ▶ The assistant presses **Reply**: only the officer gets the answer.
- ▶ The assistant presses **Reply All**: the officer and the clerk both get the answer.
- ▶ The assistant presses **Forward** to the record keeper: a new message carries the original notice onward.

Exam reading

“Answers only the sender” is Reply; “answers everyone visible” is Reply All; “sends it onward” is Forward.

Webmail vs Email Client

Point	Webmail	Email client
Runs in	Browser	Installed app
Examples	Gmail, Yahoo Mail, Outlook.com	Outlook, Thunderbird
Storage	Mail stays on the server	May download to the machine

Trap alert

Webmail is mail used through a browser; a client is a separate mail app. Gmail the website is webmail; Outlook the desktop app is a client.

POP3 and IMAP in One Slide

- ▶ An email client collects mail using one of two incoming protocols.
- ▶ **POP3** — Post Office Protocol version 3 — **downloads** mail to the local machine (usually removing it from the server).
- ▶ **IMAP** — Internet Message Access Protocol — keeps mail **synced** on the server, so every device sees the same folders.
- ▶ Outgoing mail in both cases is normally sent with **SMTP** — Simple Mail Transfer Protocol.

One-line contrast

POP3 downloads; IMAP syncs; SMTP sends.

Composing and Sending, Step by Step

- ▶ Open a new message and fill **To** (and Cc/Bcc if needed).
- ▶ Write a short meaningful **subject**; write the **body**.
- ▶ Attach files if needed and **re-check** the recipient list.
- ▶ Press Send: a copy goes to **Sent**, and the message waits in each recipient's **Inbox**.
- ▶ An interrupted composition saved midway waits in **Drafts**.

Trap Alert: Email Facts to Keep Straight

- ▶ **@** separates user name (left) and domain name (right). (PYQ-35)
- ▶ **Bcc** hides recipients from each other, not from the sender; To/Cc stay visible. (TRAP-16)
- ▶ **Reply** answers the sender; **Reply All** answers all visible recipients; **Forward** passes the message onward.
- ▶ **Drafts** holds unsent work; **Sent** holds copies of sent mail; **Spam** is not the delete bin.
- ▶ **Webmail** runs in a browser; an **email client** is an installed app; **POP3** downloads while **IMAP** syncs.

Lesson 37: Recall

- ▶ An address is `user-name@domain-name`; the @ divides the two parts.
- ▶ To is the main recipient; Cc is a visible copy; Bcc is a hidden copy.
- ▶ Subject states the topic; body carries the message; attachments carry files.
- ▶ Inbox receives; Sent keeps sent copies; Drafts holds unfinished mail; Spam holds junk; Trash holds deleted mail.
- ▶ Reply answers the sender, Reply All answers all visible recipients, Forward sends the message onward.
- ▶ Webmail lives in the browser; an email client is installed software using POP3/IMAP for incoming mail and SMTP for outgoing mail.